

# Zapier at the center of your pipelines

When No-Code agility turns into a financial and security bottleneck. 🛑

## The context

For many startups, Zapier is the logical first step: it's fast and it works. But as data volume grows and logic becomes critical, the "pay per task" model stops being an advantage and becomes a strategic risk. If your engineering team is dealing with these realities, it's time to evaluate a move to Native Orchestration:

## Why engineers shift to wpipe

- The Complexity Ceiling: Visual automations struggle with complex loops, nested conditional logic, and atomic retries.
- OPEX vs. Engineering: Do you really want your bill to grow linearly with your success?

### Code-first

Pipelines are Python: versionable, testable, reviewable in Git.

### Checkpoints

State persisted to SQLite WAL at every step; resume, don't restart.

### Independently lean

<50MB RAM. No broker, no daemon, no metadata server.

## What it looks like

```
from wpipe import Pipeline, step

@step(name="sync", retry_count=3, retry_delay=5)
def sync(data):
    return {"status": push_to_crm(data["lead"])}

pipe = Pipeline(pipeline_name="zap_to_wpipe", tracking_db="sync.db")
pipe.set_steps([sync])
```

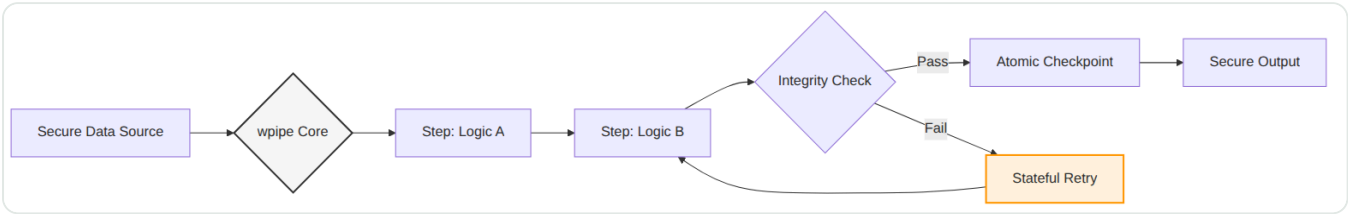
## At a glance

| Dimension        | Zapier (SaaS)           | wpipe (Software Engineering)          |
|------------------|-------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Data Sovereignty | Third-party dependency  | Total (In-house / Local-first)        |
| Operating Cost   | Volume-based (Variable) | Predictable (Own infrastructure)      |
| Robustness       | Proprietary black box   | Transparent (Real stack traces)       |
| Resilience       | Generic retries         | SQLite Checkpoints (Persistent state) |

| Dimension | Zapier (SaaS)      | wpipe (Software Engineering) |
|-----------|--------------------|------------------------------|
| Lifecycle | Manual (Shadow IT) | Git-First (Standard CI/CD)   |

## Under the hood

The flow behind the post, as wpipe renders it from code.



**+117k downloads**

A community of efficiency-first developers.

**<50MB RAM**

Fits containers, VMs, and Raspberry Pi-class hardware.

**SQLite WAL**

Industrial durability without a database to administer.

## Next step

wpipe is a Python library — try it in your next pipeline:

```
pip install wpipe
```

Steps stay functions you already understand. Docs, diagrams, and dashboards follow. Explore **Zapier** workflows at [wpipe.readthedocs.io](https://wpipe.readthedocs.io).

wpipe · Python-native orchestration with SQLite WAL checkpoints, retries, timeouts, parallelism, and self-documenting flows. +117k downloads.